Inspect360 HMO Licence Functionality

Complete product guide — upload, extract, assess, findings, cases and evidence.
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> **Important disclaimer:** HMO assessment in Inspect360 is a *document and evidence status* workflow. It is **not** a legal compliance certificate and does not prove lawful operation of an HMO.

1. Purpose

The HMO Compliance module helps property managers collect HMO licence documents, extract key fields, run rule-based checks against the property record, track gaps in evidence, and open remediation cases when critical issues appear.

Typical users: landlords, agents, compliance officers, and Inspect360 admins with HMO permissions.

2. Where it lives in the product

- **Sidebar:** HMO Compliance (portfolio / cases dashboard)
- **Property page:** HMO panel on a property (upload licence, review extraction, run assessment)
- **Module gate:** Requires the HMO Compliance company module to be enabled for the organisation

3. End-to-end workflow

1. **Enable module** — Organisation must have HMO Compliance turned on.
2. **Open a property** — Go to the property and use the HMO panel.
3. **Upload & extract** — Upload a PDF or image of the HMO licence. The system stores the file and extracts fields into a draft licence version.
4. **Review extracted fields** — Check licence number, authority, dates, address, holder, etc. Re-upload if extraction looks wrong.
5. **Run assessment** — Runs deterministic licence checks (LIC-01…LIC-05 and related stubs) against the extraction + property record.
6. **Review findings & status** — Overall property HMO status and evidence completeness update.
7. **Case / tasks (when needed)** — Critical expiry or missing schedules can open an HMO case with remediation tasks.
8. **Close the loop** — Upload better evidence, re-assess, complete tasks, and close cases when verified.

4. Upload & extract

4.1 Accepted files

PDF, JPG/JPEG, PNG, WebP, HEIC/HEIF, GIF, BMP (and plain text for fixtures). Max size typically 25 MB.

4.2 What extraction produces

A structured licence extraction object, including:

Field	Meaning
Property address	Address printed on the licence
Licence number	Council licence reference
Issuing authority	Council / borough that issued the licence
Issue date / expiry date	Validity window of the uploaded document
Maximum individuals	Max occupancy stated on the licence (when found)
Holder / manager	Named licence holder or manager
Conditions	Extracted licence conditions (when available)
Missing attachments	Schedules/annexes referenced but not present in the upload
Confidence	Per-field confidence (e.g. Low confidence when OCR fails)

4.3 How extraction works

- **PDF text:** Text layer parsed from the PDF when available.
- **Images / scans:** Vision / OCR when AI keys are configured.
- **Heuristic + AI parsers:** Map free text into structured fields; content is treated as untrusted data.
- **Versioning:** Each upload creates a licence version (draft → current after confirmation/assessment flow).

> If licence number shows **"Not found"** or **Low confidence**, assessment will flag gaps. Prefer a clear multi-page licence PDF (including schedules) before relying on results.

5. Run assessment — detailed behaviour

Run assessment does *not* re-read the PDF. It evaluates the already-extracted fields against the property record using fixed rules, then saves:

- An **assessment** record
- Individual **findings** (one per check)
- Updated **overall status** and **evidence completeness %**
- Optionally an **HMO case** + tasks

- An **audit event** (`assessment.run`)

5.1 Licence checks (LIC)

Check	What it evaluates	Typical outcomes
LIC-01	Address on licence vs property address	Match → compliant; postcode-only match → human review; mismatch → critical review (no auto-link)
LIC-02	Licence number + issuing authority present	Missing → evidence missing; present → still needs human authenticity review (upload ≠ council verification)
LIC-03	Expiry date vs today	Future expiry → document valid window OK; expired → critical review (does not assert unlawful operation); missing date → evidence missing
LIC-04	Licence holder vs landlord/contact on file	Missing holder → evidence missing; mismatch → potential risk / review
LIC-05	Referenced schedules/annexes missing from upload	Missing attachments → evidence missing (high); none flagged → compliant for this check

5.2 Broader check stubs (not fully assessed yet)

Additional checks are reserved and currently return **EVIDENCE_MISSING** until occupancy/room/amenity/safety data is supplied:

OCC-01…03 (occupancy), ROOM-01/02 (room sizes/use), AMEN-01 (amenities), SAF-01 (safety certificates), COND-01 (conditions/hazards), LOC-01 (local standards), PLAN-01 (planning), MGMT-01 (display/notices).

5.3 Finding statuses

Status	Meaning
VERIFIED_COMPLIANT	Check passed based on available evidence
CONFIRMED_NON_COMPLIANT	Confirmed failure against a requirement
POTENTIAL_RISK	Possible issue needing investigation
EVIDENCE_MISSING	Cannot decide — needed document/data not present
REQUIRES_HUMAN_REVIEW	Rule cannot auto-decide safely
NOT_APPLICABLE	Check does not apply

5.4 Overall property statuses

Status	Meaning (UI label)
NOT_ASSESSED	Not assessed yet
VERIFIED_COMPLIANT	Verified compliant (based on assessed checks)

REVIEW_REQUIRED	Review required
ACTION_REQUIRED	Action required
CRITICAL_EXCEPTION	Critical exception

Evidence completeness % summarises how much of the expected evidence set is present across findings.

6. Automatic case opening

After assessment, Inspect360 may open an HMO remediation case when:

- **LIC-03** is CRITICAL and not verified compliant (e.g. expired uploaded licence), or
- **LIC-05** is EVIDENCE_MISSING (missing schedules/annexes)

If an open case already exists for the property, a duplicate is not created. New cases can be seeded with remediation tasks (e.g. obtain current licensing position, upload full schedules).

6.1 Case lifecycle

OPEN → TRIAGED → IN_PROGRESS → AWAITING_EVIDENCE / AWAITING_REVIEW → READY_FOR_SIGNOFF → VERIFIED_CLOSED (also REOPENED / CANCELLED_AS_DUPLICATE).

6.2 Task lifecycle

OPEN → ASSIGNED → IN_PROGRESS → EVIDENCE_REQUESTED → EVIDENCE_RECEIVED → AWAITING_VERIFICATION → VERIFIED_CLOSED (also REOPENED / CANCELLED).

7. Licence document lifecycle

State	Meaning
DRAFT	Uploaded / extracted, not yet treated as the live position
CURRENT	Active document version for the property
EXPIRED_DOCUMENT	Uploaded document past expiry
RENEWAL_PENDING_EVIDENCE	Renewal in progress; evidence still needed
SUPERSEDED	Replaced by a newer version
UNDER_REVIEW	Human review in progress

8. Permissions

Access is gated by role permissions, including:

- `hmo.licence.upload` / `hmo.licence.confirm`
- `hmo.assessment.run`

- `hmo.case.read` / `hmo.case.write` / `hmo.case.assign`
- `hmo.critical.close`, `hmo.occupancy.read`, `hmo.notification.send`, `hmo.rule.approve`

9. Related capabilities (beyond the licence button)

- **Occupancy checks** — Compare household/occupancy against licence maxima (OCC checks).
- **Room baselines** — England sleeping-room floor-area baselines (Housing Act 2004 Sch.4) for ROOM checks when room data exists.
- **Dashboard / metrics** — Portfolio views of statuses, open cases, evidence gaps.
- **Bulk import** — Idempotent licence import by content hash for large portfolios.
- **Audit trail** — Assessment runs and key actions are audited.
- **Integrations** — Adapters (e.g. Reapit) can feed property context where configured.

10. Practical operator guide

1. Upload the full licence pack (main grant + schedules/annexes).
2. Confirm extracted fields before assessing — especially address, number, expiry.
3. Click **Run assessment**.
4. If status is Action/Critical/Review, open the case and complete evidence tasks.
5. Re-upload corrected documents and re-run assessment after fixes.
6. Treat "Verified compliant" as *document/evidence status for assessed checks*, not legal advice.

11. Common outcomes explained

What you see	What it usually means
Licence number "Not found"	OCR/heuristic could not read the number — re-upload a clearer PDF
Setup / draft badge	Extraction saved; assessment not yet relied on as final
SMS/credits unrelated	Billing credits are separate from HMO module entitlement
Case opened after assess	Expired licence document and/or missing schedules triggered remediation
Many EVIDENCE_MISSING findings	Room/occupancy/safety data not yet supplied — expected for licence-only uploads